

Clinical Study Summary Report (CSSR)

Document Status: Final | Version: 1.0 | Date: 01-APR-2026

1. Administrative & Study Identification

Full Study Title:	A Phase II, Multi-part, Randomized, Open-label, Assessor-blinded, Active-controlled, Multicenter Study to Evaluate the Efficacy and Safety of Rapcabtagene Autoleucel Versus Rituximab Treatment in Participants With Severe Refractory Diffuse Cutaneous Systemic Sclerosis
Short Title:	Phase 2 Study Evaluating Rapcabtagene Autoleucel in Participants With Diffuse Cutaneous Systemic Sclerosis
Protocol Number:	561005131862448168
NCT Number:	NCT06655896
Sponsor Name:	Novartis
Investigational Product:	rituximab
Phase:	PHASE2
Medical Monitor:	[Not Provided in Posting]

2. Study Synopsis & Rationale

2.1 Study Objective

Primary Objective: 1. Achievement of a treatment response as per the Revised Composite Response Index in Systemic Sclerosis 50 (rCRISS50) definition at Week 52.: To demonstrate the superiority of rapcabtagene autoleucel as a single infusion compared to rituximab, with respect to the proportion of participants achieving a Revised Composite Response Index in Systemic Sclerosis 50 (rCRISS50) response at Week 52.

This response is assessed across 5 assessment domains: (1) modified Rodnan Skin Score (mRSS), (2) Health Assessment Questionnaire Disability Index (HAQ-DI), (3) patient global assessment (PGA), (4) physician global assessment (PhGA) and (5) percent-predicted forced vital capacity (FVC%).

Secondary Obj.: 1. Change from baseline in Forced Vital Capacity (FVC)% predicted at Week 52 2. Change from baseline in modified Rodnan Skin Score (mRSS) at Week 52. 3. Change from baseline in Health Assessment Questionnaire Disability Index (HAQ-DI) at Week 52.

2.2 Background & Rationale

The purpose of this study is to evaluate the efficacy, safety and tolerability of rapcabtagene autoleucel (administered once following lymphodepletion) in participants with severe refractory diffuse cutaneous systemic sclerosis relative to rituximab.

3. Study Design & Methodology

Design Framework: Type: INTERVENTIONAL, Phase: PHASE2, Status: RECRUITING

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Target N: 86

4. Subject Selection (Eligibility Criteria)

4.1 Inclusion Criteria

1. Participant must fulfill the 2013 American College of Rheumatology/ European League Against Rheumatism classification criteria for systemic sclerosis and meet the diffuse cutaneous SSc (dcSSc) subset classification according to LeRoy.
2. Disease onset from the first non-Raynaud symptoms attributable to SSc (e.g., puffy hands, scleroderma, digital ulcers, arthralgia, dyspnea) within 7 years prior to the Screening visit.
3. Severe, progressive systemic sclerosis disease defined by at least one of the following:
 - * Progressive systemic sclerosis-associated interstitial lung disease
 - * Severe, progressive systemic sclerosis skin disease
 - * Clinically significant systemic sclerosis-associated cardiac involvement at Screening

4.2 Exclusion Criteria

1. Any condition during Screening that could prevent a complete washout of medications as required per protocol or could otherwise make the participant ineligible for anti-CD19 CAR-T therapy and further participation in the study, as judged by the Investigator.
2. Participants with history of hypersensitivity to excipients in rapcabtagene autoleucel or to rituximab.
3. Any participant for whom treatment with rituximab is clinically inappropriate in the opinion of the investigator.
4. Any medical conditions that are not related to SSc that, in the opinion of the Investigator, would jeopardize the ability of the participant to tolerate lymphodepletion and anti-CD19 CAR-T cell therapy.
5. Rheumatic disease other than dcSSc, (except secondary Sjogren's syndrome or scleroderma myopathy), including limited cutaneous systemic sclerosis (lcSSc) or sine scleroderma at Screening.
6. Participants with pre-existing pulmonary hypertension.
7. Significant renal pathology at Screening.
8. Participants with uncontrolled stage II hypertension at Screening.
9. Vaccination with live attenuated vaccines within 6 weeks prior to randomization.

Other protocol-defined inclusion/exclusion criteria may apply.

11. Study Identifiers & Governance

Primary ID:	561005131862448168
Registry Number:	NCT06655896
Sponsor:	Novartis
Study Title:	Phase 2 Study Evaluating Rapcabtagene Autoleucel in Participants With Diffuse Cutaneous Systemic Sclerosis

15. Sign-off & Approval

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Principal Investigator: _____ Date: _____

Clinical Operations Lead: _____ Date: _____

Lead Statistician: _____ Date: _____